were put on alert, but as far as I know no attempts were made on Gorbachev's life while he was in New York. I've still worried about him: How hard and fast can he push his reforms without risking his life?

After our reunion in New York, I wrote this in my diary: "The meeting was a tremendous success. A better attitude than at any of our previous meetings. Gorbachev sounded as if he saw us as partners making a better world."

Gorbachev, George Bush, and I met privately with our interpreters on Governors Island in New York Harbor, then joined a small group of officials from both countries for lunch, where I enjoyed watching, now almost an outsider, as Gorbachev and George started to get to know each other. I felt good about it: They seemed to have a rapport that encouraged optimism for the future.

In fact, after another year and a half of hard negotiations, they would come to terms on a number of agreements, including the first phase of the START treaty based on the principles Gorbachev, George Shultz, Eduard Shevardnadze, and I worked out in 1986 in that room overlooking the sea in Reykjavik.

At one point during lunch, Gorbachev mentioned that George Bush had been a navy flier and George Shultz, who was also there, had been a marine. He joked that he felt outnumbered by American military men. He hadn't mentioned me, so I said, "Just a minute here, you've been dealing with one all the time," and he laughed.

Then the three of us went down to the waterfront where George and I showed Gorbachev the Statue of Liberty and the New York City skyline. George then left us alone and Gorbachev and I went down to a dock to say our good-byes.

We recalled some of the things that we'd said during our first meeting at Geneva about the importance of building trust between our countries and agreed that we had come a long way since then.